- Hosting a web application such as WordPress
- Operating an enterprise application, such as an ERP (enterprise resource planning) application
- Transforming or analyzing data, such as encoding video files

### *3.1.1 Launching a virtual machine*

In the following example, you will launch a virtual machine to run a tool called *LinkChecker* that checks a website for broken links. Checking for links resulting in “404 Not Found” errors improves the usability and SEO score of your website. You could run LinkChecker on your local machine as well, but an EC2 instance in Amazon’s data center offers more compute and networking capacities. As shown here, it takes only a few clicks to launch a virtual machine, which AWS calls an EC2 instance:

1. Open the AWS Management Console at https://console.aws.amazon.com.
2. Make sure you’re in the N. Virginia (US East) region (see figure 3.2), because we optimized our examples for this region.
3. Click Services and search for EC2.
4. Click Launch Instance to start the wizard for launching a virtual machine, as shown in figure 3.2.